Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	5/7/2026
Team	Bala Mahalakshmi Konakalla Chenikala Nagendra Kusuma Leela Pittala Mamidi Durga Ambika Hazara Shaik
Project name	Strategic product placement analysis: unveiling sales impact with tableau visualization

Empathy Map Canvas:

Empathy Map: Retail Manager

1. WHO are we empathizing with?

- User: Retail Store Manager / Category Analyst.
- Goal: To maximize sales by placing the right products in the right spots.

2. What do they SEE?

- Complicated spreadsheets with rows of numbers.
- "Dead zones" in the store where customers don't stop.
- Competitors using advanced heat-mapping technology.

3. What do they SAY?

- "I think the bottom shelf is killing our sales for this brand."
- "We need a visual way to see our floor performance."
- "Why is this high-margin item not moving?"

4. What do they DO?

- Manually move products based on "gut feeling."
- Spend hours trying to cross-reference sales with floor maps.

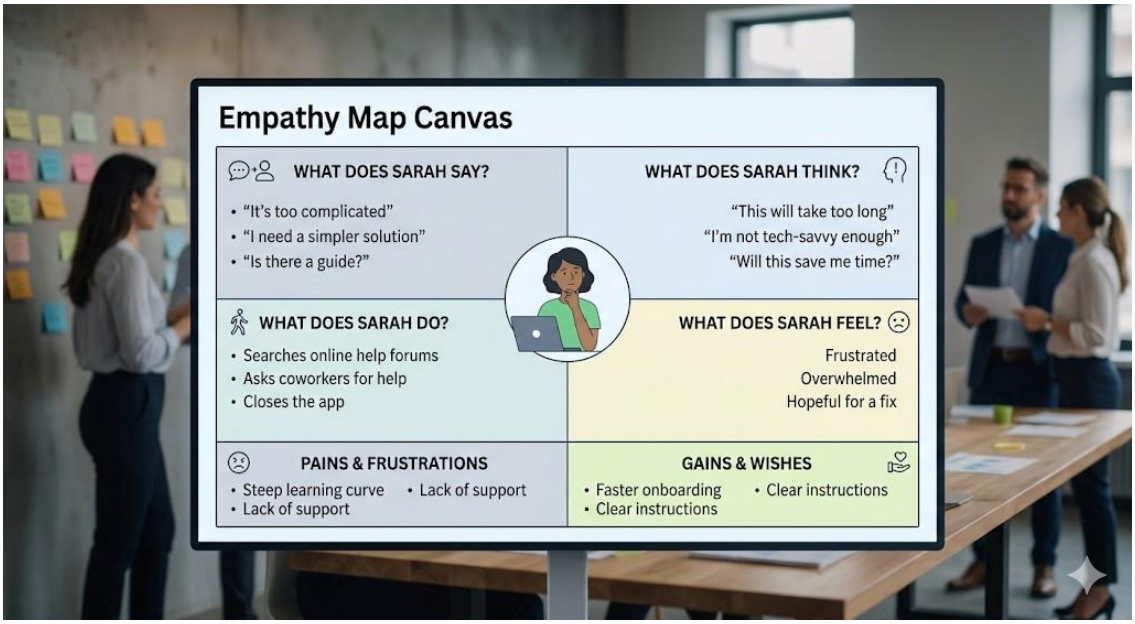
- Ask staff which aisles seem the busiest.

5. What do they HEAR?

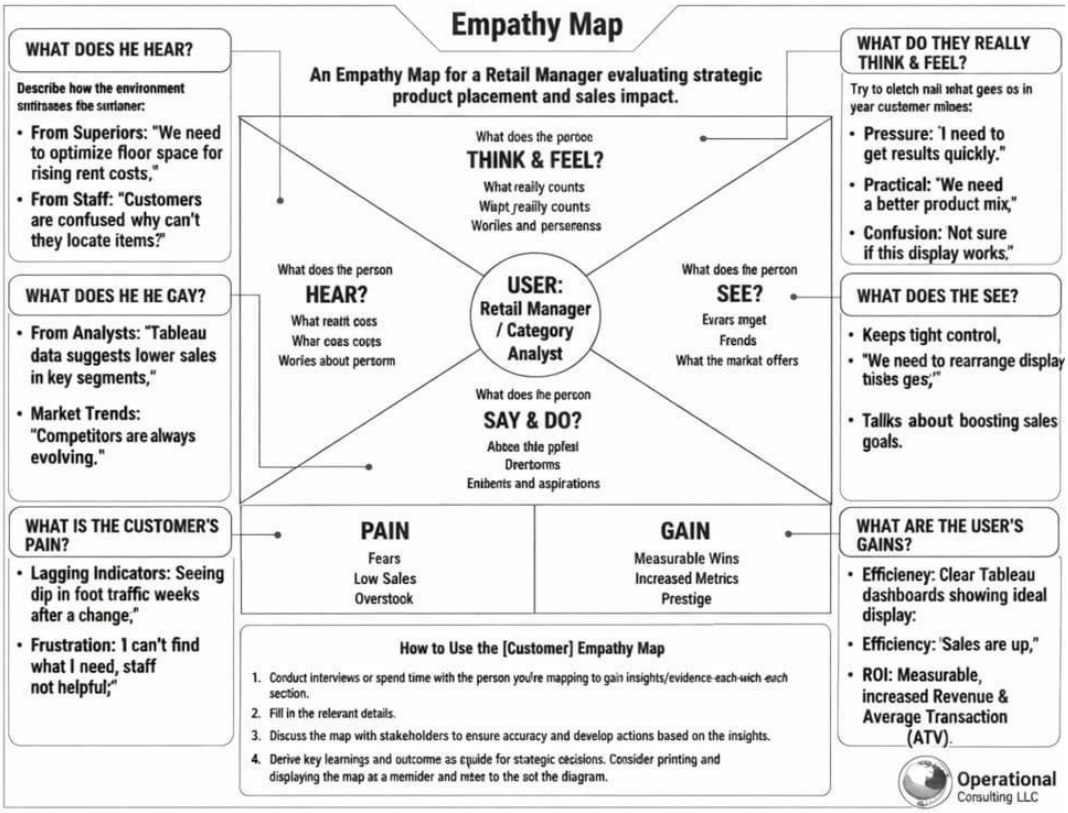
- From Boss: "Revenue per square foot must increase by 10%."
- From Staff: "Customers are complaining they can’t find the promotions."
- From Tech: "Tableau can solve this if we have the right data."

6. What do they FEEL? (Pains & Gains)

- PAIN: Frustrated by "invisible" sales losses they can't prove.
- GAIN: Excited to finally see a Heat Map that shows exactly where the money is.



Example:


Empathy Map
An Empathy Map for a Retail Manager evaluating strategic product placement and sales impact.
WHAT DOES HE HEAR?
Describe how the environment snrirsaees fbe surtianer:
• From Superiors: "We need to optimize floor space for rising rent costs,"
• From Staff: "Customers are confused why can't they locate items?"
WHAT DOES HE HE GAY?
• From Analysts: "Tableau data suggests lower sales in key segments,"
• Market Trends: "Competitors are always evolving."
WHAT IS THE CUSTOMER'S PAIN?
• Lagging Indicators: Seeing dip in foot traffic weeks after a change,"
• Frustration: 1 can't find what I need, staff not helpful;"
What does the perdoe
THINK & FEEL?
What reaiily counts
Wiapt ,reaiily counts
Woriles and perserenss
What does the person
HEAR?
What reairt coss
Whar coas copts
Wories about persorm
USER:
Retail Manager / Category Analyst
What does the person
SEE?
Evrars mget
Frends
What the markat offers
What does the person
SAY & DO?
Abtee thle ppfesl
Drertorms
Enibents and aspirations
PAIN
Fears
Low Sales
Overstook
GAIN
Measurable Wins
Increased Metrics
Prestige
How to Use the [Customer] Empathy Map
1. Conduct interviews or spend time with the person you're mapping to gain insights/evidence each wich each section.
2. Fill in the relevant details.
3. Discuss the map with stakeholders to ensure accuracy and develop actions based on the insights.
4. Derive key learnings and outcome as equide for stategic cecisions. Consider printing and displaying the map at a memider and mtee to the sot the diagram.
WHAT DO THEY REALLY THINK & FEEL?
Try to oletch nali sehat gees os in year customer miloes:
• Pressure: 'I need to get results quickly."
• Practical: "We need a better product mix,"
• Confusion: Not sure if this display works."
WHAT DOES THE SEE?
• Keeps tight control,
• "We need to rearrange display tisès ges;'"
• Talks about boosting sales goals.
WHAT ARE THE USER'S GAINS?
• Efficieney: Clear Tableau dashboards showing ideal display:
• Efficiency: 'Sales are up,"
• ROI: Measurable, increased Revenue & Average Transaction (ATV).
Operational
Consulting LLC